Digital Literacy Project Report

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

Student Name: Ayan Sheikh

Registration No.: 25BAI10119

Branch: B.Tech Computer Science & Engineering

Institution: VIT Bhopal University

1. Introduction

This project was completed as part of the **Student Digital Ambassador** role. The primary objective was to build a comprehensive digital literacy portfolio to help peers navigate professional online profiles, safe communication, and technical collaboration. The following report documents the completion of five specific tasks mapping to the course modules.

2. Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task of the Digital Literacy Portfolio, I designed a high-impact infographic using **Genspark AI**, an advanced AI-driven design and research tool. This tool allowed me to efficiently structure professional-grade visual content while ensuring the information was both accurate and aesthetically engaging. My design, titled "Digital Literacy Essentials," focuses on three core pillars: a clear definition of digital literacy, essential digital tools for students (such as Khan Academy for

research and Notion for collaboration), and critical internet safety practices.

The infographic emphasizes that digital literacy is not just about using technology, but about critical thinking and information ethics. I found it particularly interesting to see how the AI could suggest layouts that balanced text-heavy definitions with clean, modern icons to maintain readability. One minor challenge was fine-tuning the AI prompts to ensure the safety tips—like using unique, complex passwords and verifying sources—were prominent enough to catch a student's eye. Overall, the process highlighted how AI tools can assist a Digital Ambassador in creating professional resources quickly and effectively.

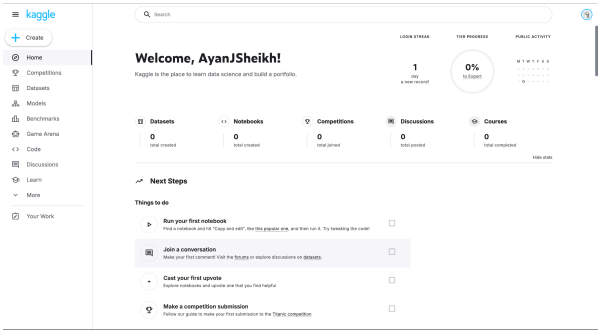
3. Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

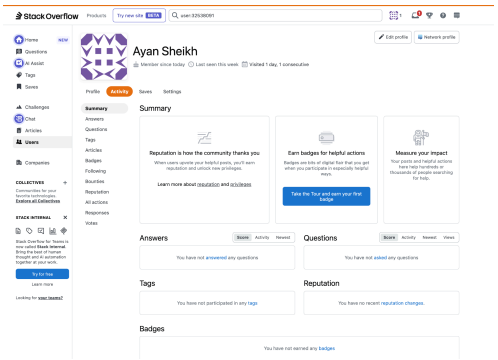
To establish a professional digital presence, I selected **LinkedIn**, **Kaggle**, and **Stack Overflow** as my primary platforms. I chose these because they represent the three pillars of a modern Computer Science career: professional

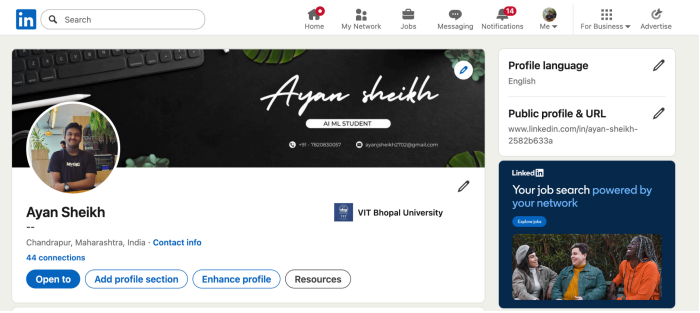
networking, data science expertise, and community-driven problem solving.

LinkedIn serves as my professional landing page, where I have documented my current education at VIT Bhopal University to connect with industry mentors and recruiters. **Kaggle** is my dedicated space for exploring data science and AI, providing access to datasets and competitions that will sharpen my machine learning skills. Finally, **Stack Overflow** allows me to engage with the global developer community by learning from established experts and eventually contributing to technical discussions.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a living record of my growth. I will post my project milestones on LinkedIn, participate in Kaggle competitions to build a technical portfolio, and use Stack Overflow to troubleshoot complex coding challenges. By maintaining these accounts, I aim to transition from a student to a career-ready professional with a verified digital footprint.



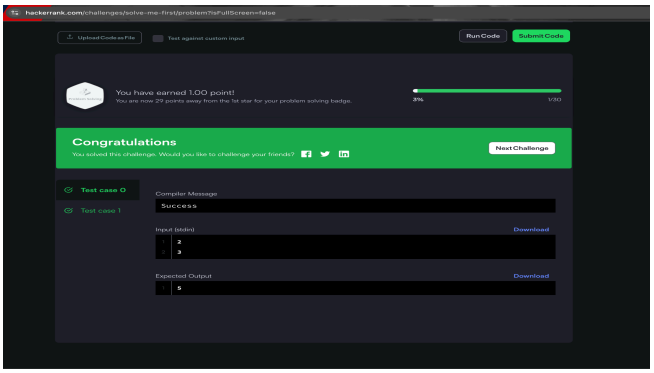




4. Task 3: Platforms & Collaboration

To fulfill the requirements of Module 3, I utilized **HackerRank** for technical skill development and **Google Forms** to practice cloud-based collaboration. On **HackerRank**, I successfully completed the "Solve Me First" challenge, which served as a practical exercise in basic programming logic and platform familiarity. On the collaboration front, I designed and deployed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using **Google Forms,** featuring a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions to assess the digital savvy of my peers.

These tools are highly significant for my academic journey in Computer Science. **HackerRank** provides a structured environment to consistently enhance my coding skills, preparing me for technical interviews and competitive programming. Meanwhile, **Google Forms** is an essential productivity tool that allows me to gather data, conduct research, and collaborate effectively on group projects. By mastering these platforms, I am building a toolkit that supports both my logical problem-solving abilities and my capacity to lead digital awareness initiatives within my college community.



Link**:**
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSffqv4kFMJyXKfrmSg-rxhtCHgbepWxb9WvqyTlWEvAX0oR6g/viewform?usp=header

5. Task 4: Email Etiquette & Social Media Checklist

Email 1: A professional request to Professor Tauseef Qamar for an assignment extension due to medical reasons.
Email 2: A formal inquiry to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a Data Science Summer Internship, highlighting my 3.8 GPA and project on AQI trends.

Social Media Checklist:

The Responsible Social Media Checklist

✅ DO'S (The Green Flags)	❌ DON'TS (The Red Flags)
Audit your privacy settings to ensure only friends see your personal photos and locations.	**Don't post in the heat of the moment** or when you're feeling highly emotional or angry.
Network with professionals and alumni in the AI and CS fields to build your future career.	**Don't share sensitive data** like your hostel room number, student ID, or daily schedule.
Fact-check before sharing news or articles to avoid spreading digital misinformation.	**Don't engage with "trolls"** or participate in online harassment/cyberbullying.
Showcase your projects, such as GitHub repos or AI models, to build a "digital portfolio."	**Don't post content that violates college policy** or shows illegal activities.
Use "Two-Factor Authentication" (2FA) to keep your accounts secure from being hacked.	**Don't plagiarize** others' code or creative work and claim it as your own.

In professional settings, poor digital communication often leads to missed opportunities or damaged reputations. A common real-world scenario involves a student sending a casual, poorly structured email to an internship coordinator—using "hey" instead of a formal salutation and failing to include a clear subject line. In such cases, the recruiter often ignores the email

entirely, perceiving the candidate as unprofessional or lacking attention to detail.

To prevent this, the student should have followed a standard professional email structure: a concise subject line (e.g., "Internship Inquiry - Ayan Sheikh"), a formal greeting, and a clear, respectful body. Additionally, using a "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist helps maintain a positive digital footprint, ensuring that private casual habits do not bleed into professional interactions. Mastering these communication nuances is essential for any Digital Ambassador to successfully bridge the gap between academic life and the corporate world.

6. Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

Researching this topic, especially from the perspective of an AI and CS student, really opened my eyes to how the "human element" is often the weakest link in any security system. What surprised me most was the sheer psychological manipulation behind **UPI "Collect Request" scams**. I always assumed cybercrime was about complex code or brute-force hacking, but realizing that people are losing lakhs just by being rushed into entering a PIN—something we do dozens of times a week—was a huge wake-up call. It's less about software bugs and more about exploiting human urgency.

As a result, the one habit I am personally changing is my **public Wi-Fi usage**. I used to casually check my VIT student portal or even my bank balance while hanging out in cafes or common campus areas without a second thought. From now on, I've committed to never accessing any sensitive account on

public networks without a **VPN**, ensuring my data stays encrypted and out of reach from "sniffing" attacks.

7. Conclusion

This project successfully provided a hands-on foundation for my digital career. I have learned how to brand myself professionally, communicate with faculty, and stay safe in an increasingly complex digital landscape.

8. References

- VITyarthi E-Learning Platform
- HackerRank (hackerrank.com)
- National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)
- The Hindu (Source for UPI Scam)